



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

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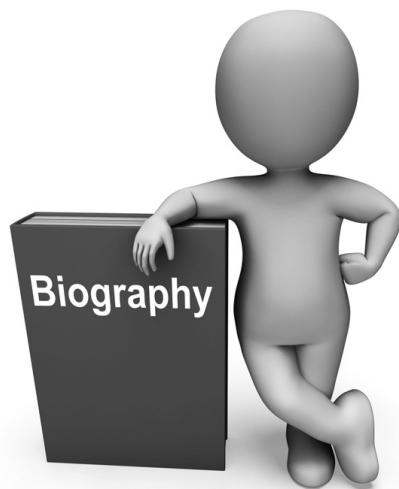
CONTENT

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: The man behind the words



Learning Outcome

Discuss factual and abstract information about common everyday or job related topics in both work and social contexts appropriate for the interlocutor.

Ask your partner:

- How often do you read an author's biography?
- Would you ever read a book based on a writer's background? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

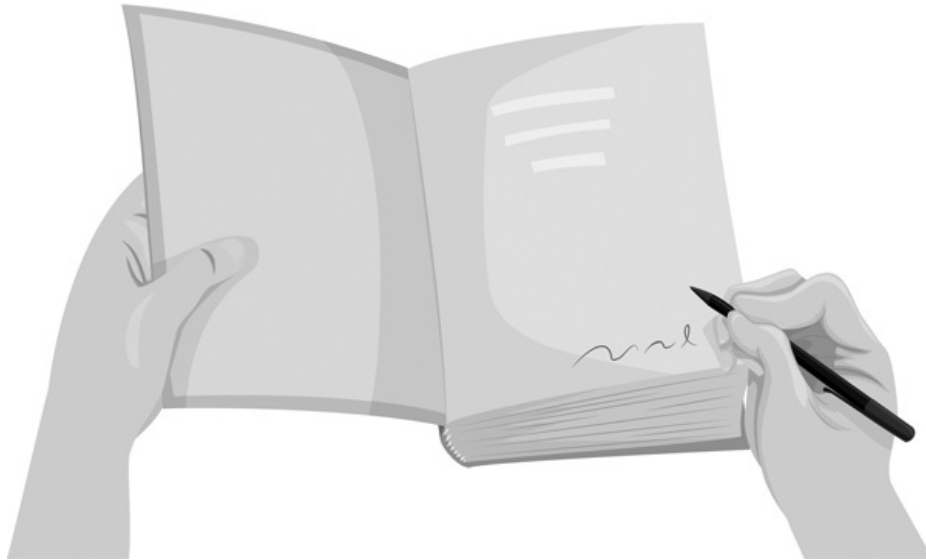
- I can write an article about an author bio.
- I can write facts about a person's life and his/her work.
- I can write about true, untrue, and possible events in present and past.





Let's Explore!

Kristi writes Richard Duncan's biography.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Richard Duncan is an award-winning novelist, children's author, poet and comedic writing expert. Originally hailing from Nantucket, an isolated island off Cape Cod, Duncan began writing in the late 80s. The spring of 2006 marked a new chapter in his life when his delightful children's book, *A Mother's Gift* was picked up by a local publisher. Since then, a number of his books have received critical acclaim including, *When Butterflies Cry*, *The Sliver*, and *Horace, The Hamster*.

Success and fame must have come as a shock to this shy, mild-mannered writer. He might not be as extroverted as some celebrities however, his energy and enthusiasm for life drips off each page. His foray into writing might not have ever happened if he hadn't lost his job as a flight attendant when his first son was born. Duncan believes that his early struggles may in fact have been the key to his success. He could have chosen to give up but instead he identified his strengths and persisted.

This international best-selling author draws inspiration from the imaginations of fellow writers and credits them as much as anyone for guiding his literary journey. Richard's hobbies include gardening, beach walks, reading and spending time with his family. When he's not traveling for book signing or mentoring budding talent, you might find Richard on his sailboat with his devoted Labrador retriever, off the coast of Massachusetts. You won't see him around town. He is believed to be vacationing on the water this summer. Despite not wanting people to be considering his work as ground-breaking, he will go down in writing folklore as a gifted and unassuming genius.





Let's Practice!

Duncan's energy and enthusiasm for life drips off each page*.

* "Drips off each page" means that his writing is full of emotion.

Instructions: Use the options from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

Retriever / Cape / hailing / credits / was picked up / inspiration / guiding / acclaim / struggles / key / signing / marked

- Originally _____ from Nantucket, an isolated island off _____ Cod, Duncan began writing in the late 80s.
- The spring of 2006 _____ a new chapter in his life when his delightful children's book, *A Mother's Gift* _____ by a local publisher.
- This international best-selling author draws _____ from the imaginations of fellow writers.
- He _____ them as much as anyone for _____ his literary journey.
- Duncan believes that his early _____ may in fact have been the _____ to his success.
- Since then, a number of his books have received critical _____.
- When he's not traveling for book _____ or mentoring budding talent, you might find Richard on his sailboat with his devoted Labrador _____, off the coast of Massachusetts.



Let's Practice!

Let's talk about the possibilities.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Complete the sentence with the correct option. Read the complete sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

won't see

will go

might be

might not be as extroverted

must have come

could have chosen

might have never happened

- Success and fame _____ as a shock to this shy, mild-mannered writer.
- He _____ as some celebrities however, his energy and enthusiasm for life drips off each page.
- His foray into writing _____ if he hadn't lost his job as a flight attendant when his first son was born.
- Despite not wanting people to be considering his work as ground-breaking, he _____ down in writing folklore as a gifted and unassuming genius.
- You _____ him around town.
- He _____ to give up but instead he identified his strengths and persisted.
- Duncan _____ planning a sequel to his last bestseller.



Extension Activity

Do you have a favorite author? How much do you know about them?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Research your favorite author or choose one online or at a library.
- Make notes based on their background.
- Include information such as where they were born, their early years, successes and hobbies.
- Now, write an author bio based on the information in your notes.
- Be sure to organize your biography carefully. Use linking words to connect ideas.
- When completed, read your biography aloud to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I research my favorite author.

☐ ☐

I create notes based on their life and experiences.

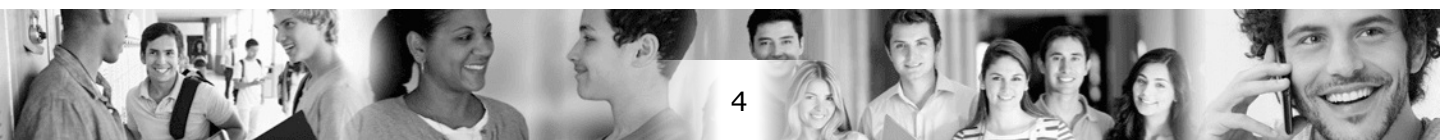
☐ ☐

I write an author bio based on the information in my notes.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to hail** (verb): to have been born or raised in a place
e.g. Originally hailing from Nantucket, Duncan began writing in the late 80s.
- cape** (noun): a large area of land that sticks out into a sea
e.g. He was born on an isolated island off Cape Cod.
- mild-mannered** (adjective): gentle and not given to extremes of emotion
e.g. Success and fame must have come as a shock to this shy, mild-mannered writer.
- extroverted** (adjective): an outgoing person
e.g. He is not as extroverted as some celebrities.
- foray** (noun): an attempt to do something especially for the first time
e.g. His foray into writing might never have happened if he hadn't lost his job as a flight attendant
- Labrador retriever** (noun): a dog that is used for retrieving birds or animals
e.g. You might find Richard on his sailboat with his devoted Labrador retriever.
- unassuming** (adjective): not having or showing a desire to be noticed
e.g. He will go down in writing folklore as a gifted and unassuming genius.
- to mark** (verb): to indicate the occurrence of
e.g. The spring of 2006 marked a new chapter in his life.
- to pick up** (verb): to accept, to agree to use
e.g. His delightful children's book, **A Mother's Gift** was picked up by a local publisher.
- to credit** (verb): to give honor or recognition
e.g. He credits them as much as anyone for guiding his literary journey.





Learning Points

Modals to express true, untrue, possible: will, may, might, could

You use the modals **may**, **might**, **could** and **will** to say if we think something is true or likely in the present.

You use them with the past participle to speculate about the possibility of something happening in the past. However, **will have** is only for the present and future.

Look at the examples:

You **may/might/could very well** be right. (It's likely now)

You **may/might/could** have a point there. (It's not impossible)

That'**ll be** my father on the phone. (I'm quite sure)

When speculating about the past, you use **could have**, **would have** and **might have**.

For example:

They **may have finished** already.

The nurse **couldn't have had** a chance to check your blood yet.

Note:

You use *may not/might not* to express possibility, you use *could not* to talk about deduction and ability.

Examples:

- *Duncan might be planning a sequel to his last bestseller.*
- *Success and fame must have come as a shock to this shy, mild-mannered writer.*
- *You won't see him around town.*
- *He might not be as extroverted as some celebrities however, his energy and enthusiasm for life drips off each page.*
- *His foray into writing might never have happened if he hadn't lost his job as a flight attendant when his first son was born.*
- *Despite not wanting people to be considering his work as ground-breaking, he will go down in writing folklore as a gifted and unassuming genius.*
- *He could have chosen to give up but instead he identified his strengths and persisted.*





Learning Points

How To Write an Author Biography

An author bio is more than just information about the author. How you present the information is as important as what you are presenting. A bio is something many readers will see before ever reading a book, so its tone may lead them to make assumptions about your book's contents.

Here are some tips and ideas on how to write an author bio:

- Title the biography with the author's name.
- Write in the third person. Example: He not I
- Keep the length of an author biography to a maximum of 250-300 words.

What do you need to include in an author bio?

1. Where the author lives
2. Work history and any writing credentials/prizes
3. Life experience and hobbies
4. Family (You need to be careful about how much information you provide)

Here are some example sentences from an author biography.

Examples:

- *Richard Duncan is an award-winning novelist, children's author, poet and comedic writing expert.*
- *Since then, a number of his books have received critical acclaim including, **When Butterflies Cry, The Sliver, and Horace, The Hamster.***
- *Richard's hobbies include gardening, beach walks, reading and spending time with his family.*

